



Tap First, Ask Later

Parent Trust in a High School Gate-Scanner's Attendance Record

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Background

Despite a gate scanner's tap now standing in for a child's arrival at school, whether parents treat it as more authoritative than what they already know about the school run remains untested.

Aims

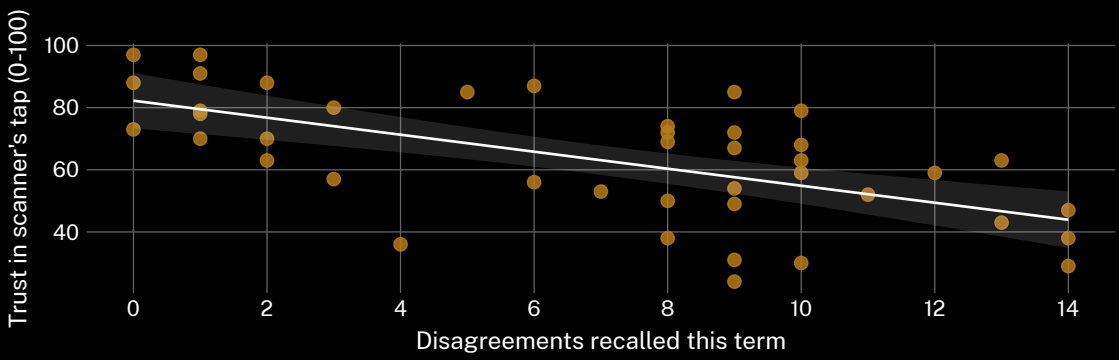
- Does trust in the scanner's "present" tap hold across repeated disagreement with what parents already know?
- What do parents do once the tap and their own knowledge diverge?
- Does unprompted recall of the last disagreement predict trust better than a prompted one?

Methods

- n = 163 parents · 5 outer-suburban high schools · one-term online survey
- 12-item Likert trust instrument + free-recall probe for the most recent tap/homeroom disagreement
- disagreement counts self-reported only; no scanner log matched to an individual response

Results

Trust in the scanner's tap fell with each additional disagreement a parent recalled ($r = -0.61$, $n = 163$), plateauing well short of outright rejection. None of the 34 parents reporting a same-day resolution changed their rating at follow-up.



Trust in the gate scanner's tap falls with each additional disagreement a parent recalls ($n = 163$, $r = -0.61$), levelling off near the scale's midpoint rather than collapsing toward zero.

Discussion & conclusions

Distrust climbs with disagreement but stalls well short of rejection — parents keep the app open at pickup regardless of what it told them that morning. The tap's authority survives contact with the school run largely intact. Next: withhold the push notification for one week per school and compare how fast trust recovers against how fast it fell.

References

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We thank the parent associations of the five participating schools. Ethics approval 2026/0142; survey responses linked only to a household code; no scanner log matched to an individual parent.

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“The tap said present. The car said otherwise.”

163 parents, five schools, one term of gate-scanner disagreements tracked to the decimal.